
LaunchLab 3

Lesson 3: Introduction to Claude Code

What is Claude Code?



Agentic Coding System

Claude Code is an agentic, terminal-based coding system. It goes beyond simple autocompletion by reading entire codebases, executing system shell commands, running pipelines, and proactively debugging failures.

For Product Designers

Democratizing engineering workflows. Builders can specify features in high-level prose to rapidly prototype, build functional microservices, and deploy complete interactive experiences without auditing code manually.



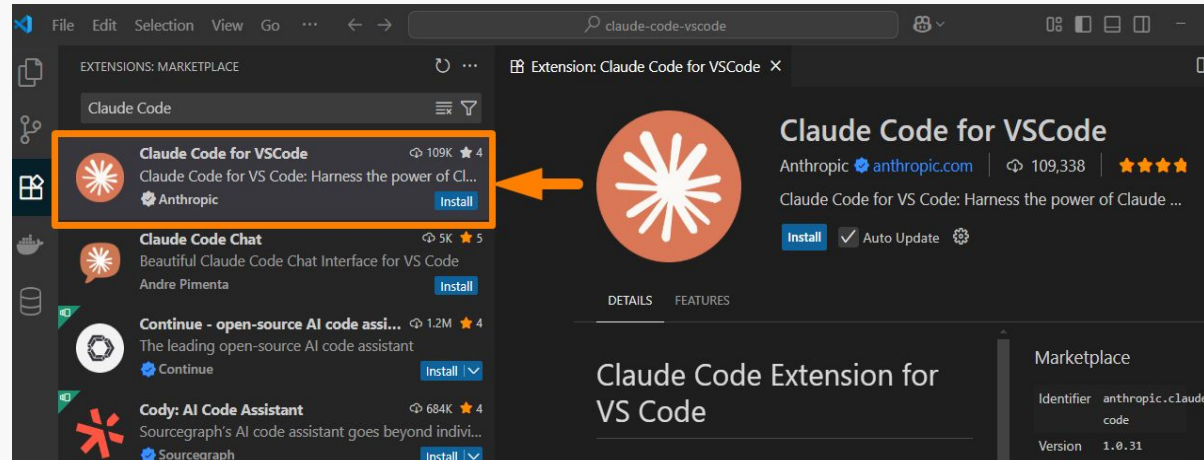
Claude Code in Visual Studio Code

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Integrated Environments

The official extension seamlessly connects Anthropic's deep logic models inside Visual Studio Code marketplaces.

- **Verified Extension:** 109K+ active developers currently utilizing the IDE plugin.
- **Autonomous Agent:** Automatically structures changes across files with robust version tracking.
- **Dependency:** Requires the Claude Code command-line module installed locally.



What It Can Do



Routines

Set automated background loops, schedule daily test checks, or configure customized multi-stage file tasks that operate directly inside the local sandboxed environment.

- "Check this folder for errors every hour."
- "Run a multi-step process: clean the files, test the code, then generate a report."
- **Key idea:** Claude Code can handle repeated background workflows inside your local project environment.

Refactoring

Seamlessly rename variables, update file layouts, and change package versions globally. Claude handles complex directory structures and maintains absolute syntax integrity.

- "Rename this variable everywhere it appears."
- "Make this code easier to read while keeping the same functionality."
- **Key idea:** Claude Code can help clean up or reorganize existing code without changing what the code actually does.

Session Context

Maintain continuous context memory trees across terminal cycles. Enables quick rollbacks, instant code explanations, and natural-language pipeline query states.

- **Key Idea:** Claude Code can keep track of
 - What commands were run.
 - What errors happened earlier.
 - What files were changed.
 - What you were trying to fix.

Claude Design



Task

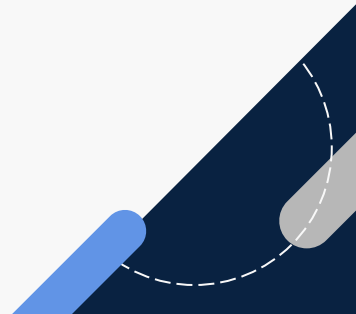


Download Claude Code onto your desktop

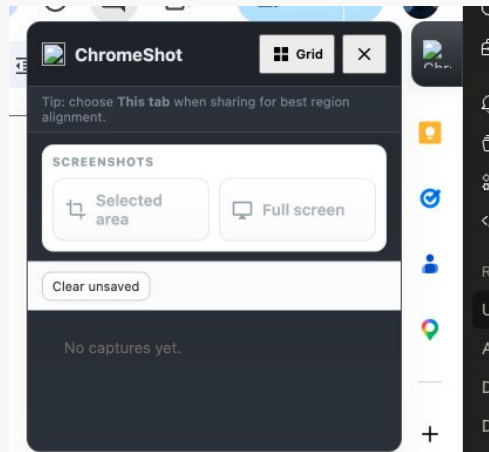
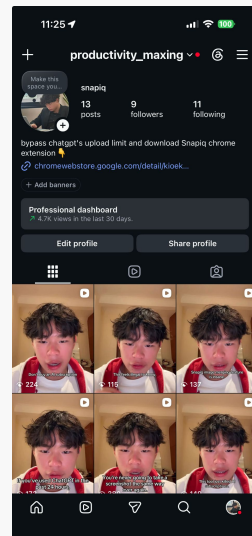
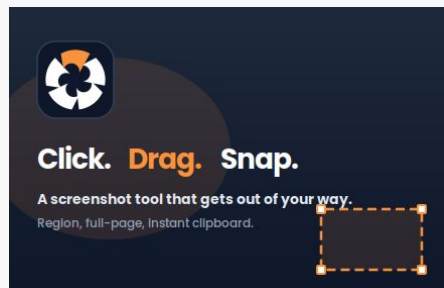
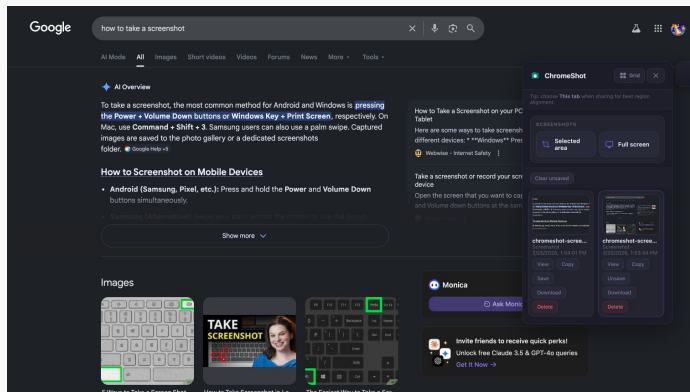
*You're each going to build a chrome extension for HW.
We will publish these extensions eventually...*

Instructions

Reach out to your tutors if you have any problems!



Yibo's Journey With Snapiq



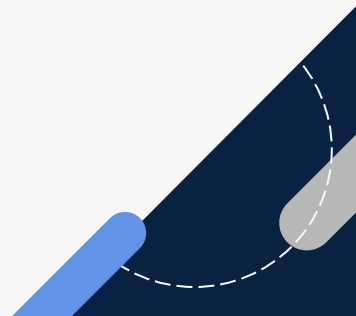
Quick Business Lesson



It's 30% the idea, 70% of the execution.

First time founders will be searching for the perfect idea, product, service. They will keep these "good" ideas to themselves. On the other hand, second time founders will be shouting their ideas to everyone in hope that someone will care enough to consider it.

People will rarely "steal" your idea. Execution is what actually matters. Most ideas are good because they already exist.



Next Lesson: Claude skills + Claude in Excel

Homework: build a Chrome extension with Claude Code. Pick something cool: a screenshot tool, a tab organizer, a YouTube speed controller, something that highlights words on any page. Must actually install in your browser and work. Bonus points if it solves a problem you genuinely have.